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Livelihood Recovery Through Market Rehabilitation

A field assessment of three priority markets in Sharg El Neel Locality

UNDP Sudan
June 23, 2026

Restoring Markets Rebuilding Livelihoods

Khartoum State · UNDP JSB Programme

UNDP is implementing a livelihood intervention in Khartoum State aimed at improving the income and resilience of **returnees and host communities** across three localities Sharg El Neel, Bahri, and Jabal Awlia. The proposed intervention focuses on two complementary pillars: **strengthening agricultural production** through the solarization of irrigation pumps for associations of small-scale farmers, and **market system rehabilitation** to restore functional trading infrastructure and improve farmers' access to profitable markets.

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priorities, UNDP conducted a series of consultations with the **Humanitarian Aid Commission (HAC)** in Khartoum State, the **State Ministry of Agriculture**, and officials from the three target localities. Technical teams from UNDP and the respective localities subsequently carried out joint site assessments of the markets proposed for rehabilitation.

> *HAC Commissioner · Khartoum State*
>
> *The Commission highly commends UNDP and its partners for the successful implementation of previous interventions in Omdurman and Khartoum localities, particularly the market cleaning and cash for works activities. We request similar support be replicated in Bahri, Sharg El Neel, and Jabal Awlia communities facing urgent recovery needs.*

The HAC Commissioner also highlighted **Ombada locality** which accommodates a significant number of IDPs from North Kordofan and continues to face major development gaps in basic services and infrastructure as a priority area for future interventions.

Market Assessment Overview – Sharg El Neel Locality, Khartoum State

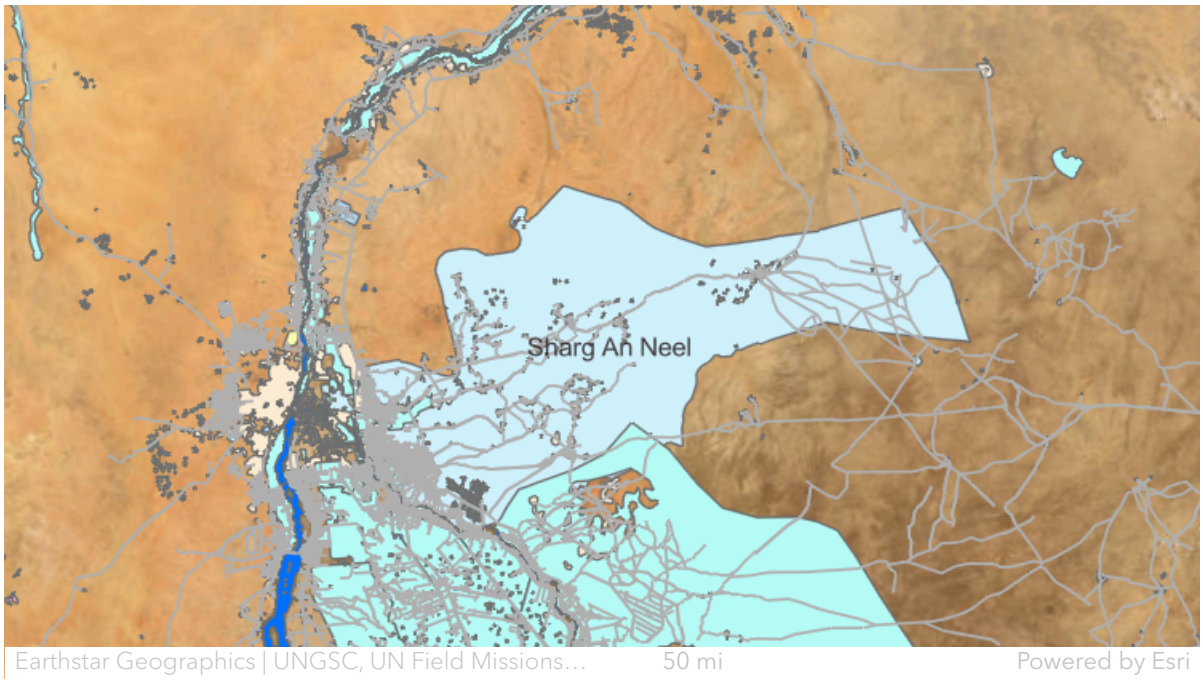
As part of UNDP's livelihood recovery intervention in Khartoum State, field teams conducted joint site assessments of three priority markets in **Sharg El Neel Locality**. The assessments carried out in coordination with locality officials and technical staff aimed to identify rehabilitation needs, infrastructure gaps, and intervention priorities to restore functional trading environments for returnees and host communities affected by the 2023 conflict.

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Sharg El Neel (East Nile) Locality is one of the largest administrative units in Khartoum State by both area and population. Spanning **7,230.7 km²**, it encompasses a diverse mix of urban, peri-urban, and rural communities along the eastern bank of the Nile including the three priority markets targeted under the UNDP JSB livelihood recovery intervention.

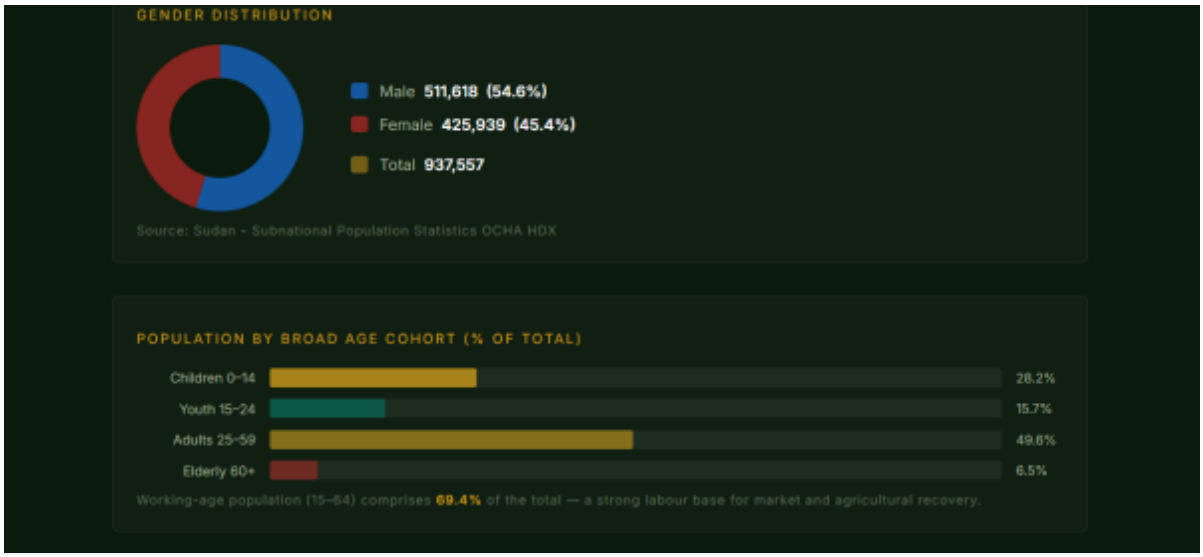
The locality has a **total registered population of approximately 937,600 people (**Source: Sudan - Subnational Population Statistics OCHA HDX- 2025**)**, with a notably young demographic profile dominated by working-age adults. The population data below provide critical context for understanding market demand, labour availability, and the scale of recovery needs across the intervention area.



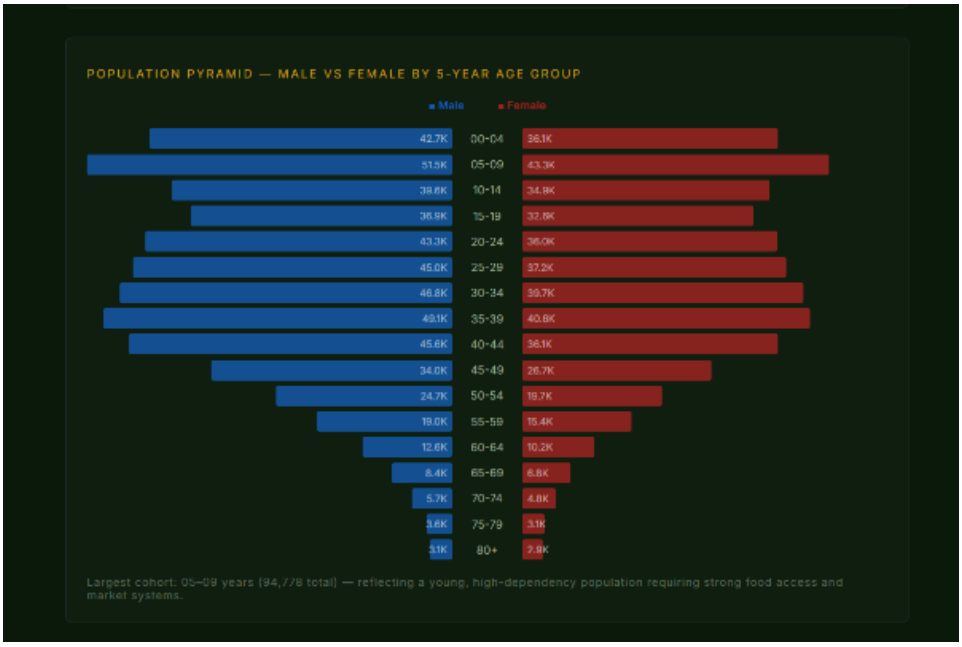
Market Profiling Assessment

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Source: Sudan - Subnational Population Statistics OCHA HDX- 2025



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With nearly **70% of residents in the working-age bracket**, Sharg El Neel has a significant economically active population that depends on functional market infrastructure for both income and food access. The concentration of population in the **25–44 age range** the primary market-trading demographic underscores the high daily footfall potential across the three assessed markets.

The relatively large share of **children under 14 (28%)** also signals strong demand for affordable food commodities,

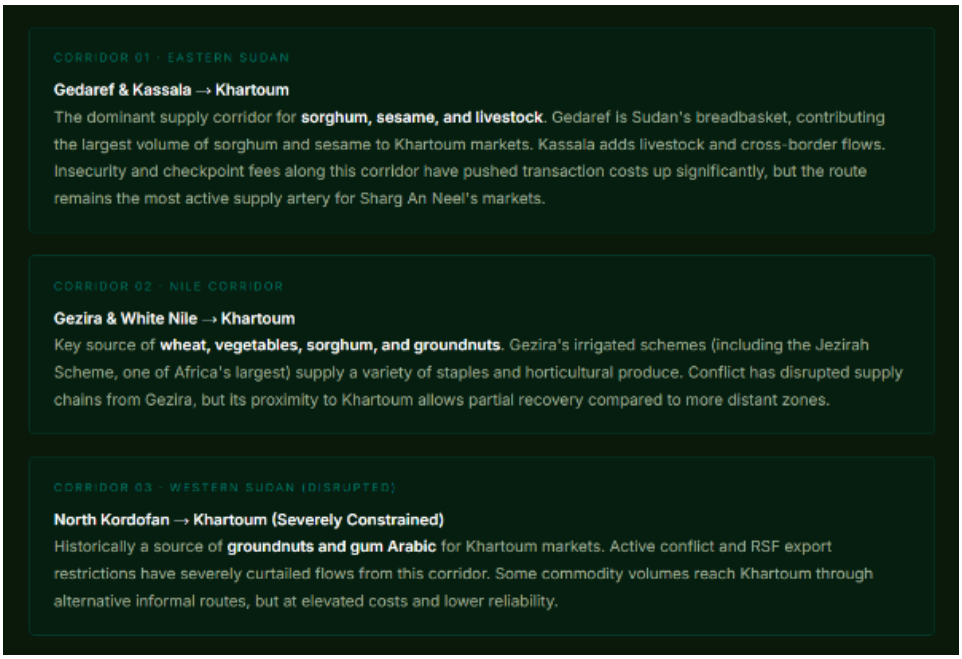
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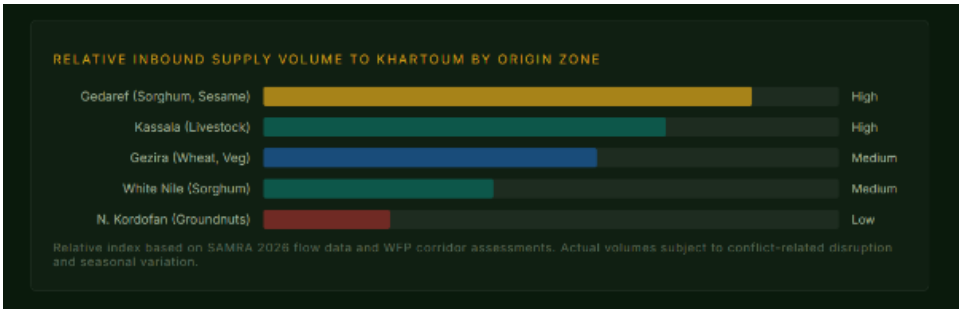
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household nutrition and food security at scale.

Key Commodity Supply Corridors

Khartoum's markets including those in Sharg An Neel are supplied by commodity flows from Sudan's main agricultural production zones. The (UNDP/ITC Sudan Agri-Food & Market Resilience Analysis (SAMRA), June 2026) identifies the following principal corridors feeding into Khartoum, all of which have been significantly disrupted since April 2023 by insecurity, checkpoint proliferation, and transport cost inflation.





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Key Commodity Supply Corridors · Conflict-Disrupted Trade Routes

Market Assessment



Hilat Kuku Vegetable Market

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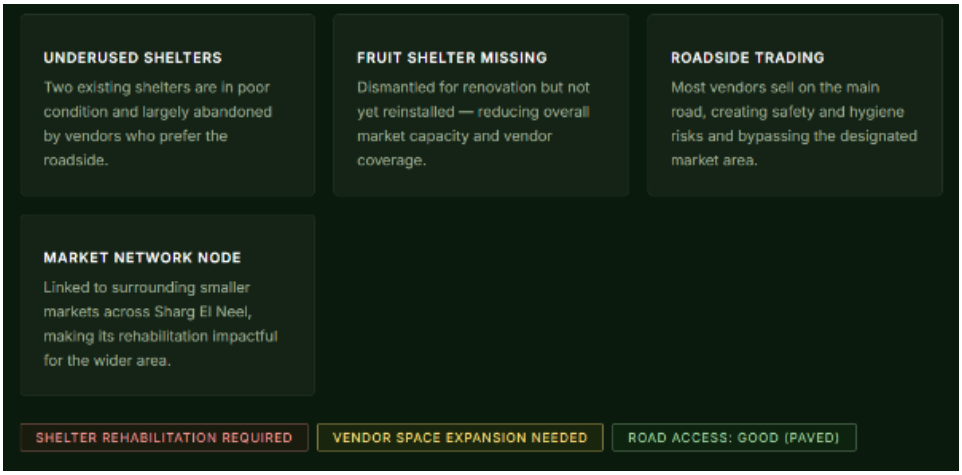
Priority Rehabilitation Site

Hilat Kuku Vegetable Market serves as one of the key retail food access points in Sharg El Neel Locality. The market is generally accessible under normal conditions via **paved roads** and is linked to a network of smaller markets distributed across the locality, giving it an important role in the local food supply chain.

The assessment found that **two existing vegetable market shelters** are available but require substantial rehabilitation. Both shelters are currently underutilized, with most vegetable and fruit vendors choosing to conduct their business along the **main road** rather than within the designated market area raising concerns about road safety, hygiene, and the loss of a structured trading environment.

A **separate fruit market shelter** previously served traders at this site but was dismantled for renovation and has not yet been reinstated. Its absence has further reduced available covered trading space, compounding the pressure on vendors to operate from the roadside.

Assessment



Market Pictures

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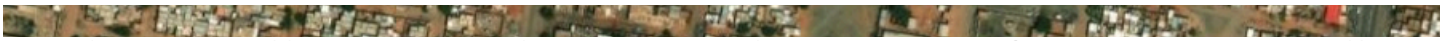
Pic1: Vegetable Market in Hilat Kuku-Most stalls are not used as vendor sell on the main road.



Pic2: Vegetable Market in Hilat Kuku-Most stalls are not used as vendor sell on the main road.

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Vantor | UNGSC, UN Field Missions GIS Teams, | UNGSC, Commercial Sat… 500 ft Powered by Esri

Soug 6 Vegetable & Fruit Market

Location: Sharg El Neel- Bahri Locality- Khartoum

New Shelter Construction Required

Soug 6 presents a distinctive two-part challenge: a severely underutilized **western market** with existing but poorly positioned infrastructure, and an interrupted construction project on the **eastern side** that holds significant potential for transforming market capacity across the locality.

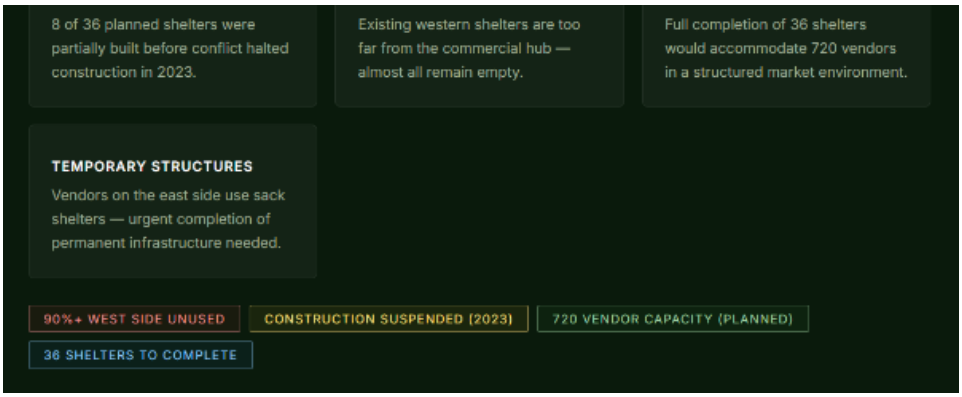
Western Vegetable Market: Existing vegetable and fruit shelters are located on the western side of the market, far from the main commercial area and primary transportation hub. Because of this poor positioning, **more than 90% of the shelters remain unused**. Vendors prefer to cluster near the eastern entrance and along the roadside where customer traffic is higher, leaving the western infrastructure idle and the investment largely wasted.

Eastern Side New Market (Incomplete): Prior to the conflict, **Akadabi Company** was contracted by the local community to construct **36 market shelters** designed to accommodate approximately **720 vendors**. Construction commenced on eight shelters but was suspended when the conflict broke out in 2023. The eight partially built structures remain on site, and completing this infrastructure would fundamentally transform market capacity and organization for Soug 6 and the broader locality. Currently, the many vendors who gravitate to the eastern side operate under makeshift shelters constructed from sacks and other temporary materials — underscoring the urgent need to complete what was already begun.

Assessment

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Site Pictures



Under-used Market in Soug-6-West Side



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Umdawan Ban Market

Location: Sharg El Neel- Bahri Locality- Khartoum

Completion of Interrupted Construction

Umdawan Ban Market is accessible under normal conditions via paved roads, though these are in poor condition. The market has an urgent and unmet need for **new vegetable market shelters** currently, most vendors operate under temporary structures made from old sacks and other unsuitable materials, with many traders also selling directly along the roadside.

The locality administration has identified **two potential locations** for the construction of new shelters. The first is the **existing vegetable market site**, which is functional but congested, with vendors concentrated in a limited and overcrowded space. The second is a site **near the main road and public transportation hub**, which offers significantly better access for both vendors and customers and would likely

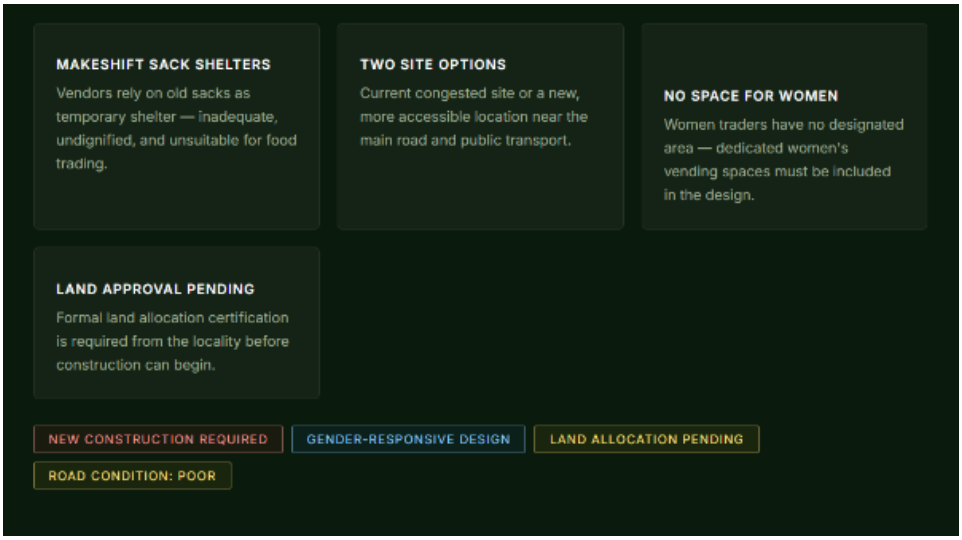
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approval and certification will be required before construction can commence at either location.

Women traders are currently without any designated selling spaces within the market. The Executive Director of the locality indicated that **dedicated areas for women vendors** can and should be incorporated into the design of the proposed market shelters a gender-responsive dimension that should be built into the intervention from the outset.

Assessment



Site Pictures

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Vegetable Market in Umdawanban made of sacks



Vegetable Market in Umdawanban made of sacks

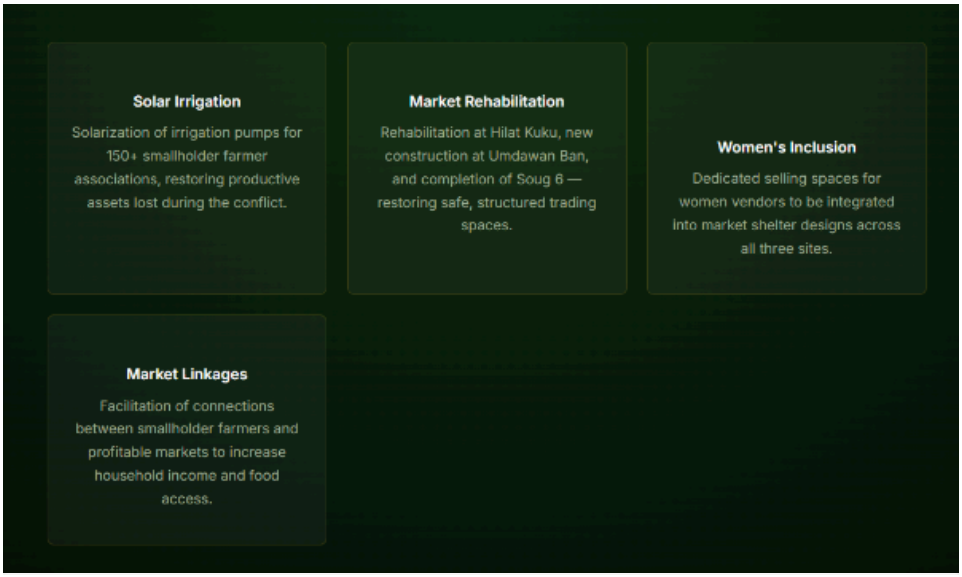
Integrated Recovery: Markets + Agriculture

The consultations and field assessments confirmed the significant and urgent need for livelihood recovery interventions across the targeted localities in Khartoum State. The findings highlight the importance of combining **agricultural support** including solar-powered irrigation systems for smallholder farmers with **market**

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livelihoods, enhance food security, increase household incomes, and contribute to the broader recovery and stabilization of communities affected by the conflict.



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